

# AHSEC 2019 — ENGLISH (29T ENGL)

*Fully Solved Paper*

## SECTION-A: Reading Skill (10 Marks)

**(a) Cite the reasons as to why some species of wild animals are on the verge of extinction. (2)**

**Ans:** Pollution, the use of pesticides, disturbance of the animals' natural environment, and man's greed and thoughtlessness are the main reasons cited for wild animal species being in danger of extinction.

**(b) What has brought about the destruction of much of the countryside? (1)**

**Ans:** An increase in population has led to more building and construction, destroying much of the countryside that provided habitat for wild animals.

**(c) Why are the polar bear and the whales under threat? (2)**

**Ans:** The polar bear in North America is under threat because it is hunted by sportsmen, while whales are massacred worldwide for the oil and food they yield.

**(d) Which animal is hunted for its fur? (1)**

**Ans:** The chinchilla (found in South America) is hunted for its fur.

**(e) Mention the ways in which wild life is currently helped. (2)**

**Ans:** Sewage pollution in the river Thames has been greatly reduced, a ban on trading in some furs has been agreed upon, and organisations like Friends of the Earth are doing valuable conservation work.

**(f) Give the adjective form of 'habitat'. (1)**

**Ans:** Habitable

**(g) Find a word in the passage which means "a great slaughter". (1)**

**Ans:** Massacred (massacre)

## SECTION-B: Advanced Writing Skills (25 Marks)

### Q2. Poster on Rain-Water Harvesting (5 marks, 50 words)

SAVE WATER, SAVE LIFE!

Water is precious — don't let it go to waste!

- Harvest rainwater on your rooftop
- Recharge groundwater, prevent flooding
- Reduce your water bills
- Secure water for future generations

ADOPT RAIN-WATER HARVESTING IN YOUR HOME TODAY!

— An initiative for a water-secure locality

### Q3. Report on Tree Plantation Week (10 marks, 100–125 words)

TREE PLANTATION WEEK CELEBRATED WITH ENTHUSIASM

[Date]: Our school recently celebrated Tree Plantation Week with great enthusiasm, organising a number of inter-school competitions highlighting the importance of ecological balance.

The week began with a plantation drive in which students planted over two hundred saplings on the school campus and nearby areas. Inter-school competitions including poster-making, elocution and essay-writing on environmental themes were organised, drawing participation from several neighbouring schools. Experts from the Forest Department were invited to speak to students about the importance of maintaining ecological balance and the role trees play in combating climate change.

The week concluded with a prize distribution ceremony, where the Principal appreciated the students' active participation and urged them to continue nurturing the environment. The programme was widely praised for successfully raising environmental awareness among students.

— Reported by Nilim/Nilima, Secretary, Eco-Club

#### **Q4. Job Application with Resume — Sales Executive (10 marks)**

From:

Asha/Amit

[Address]

[Date]

To

The Regional Director

[Name of Company]

[Address]

Subject: Application for the post of Sales Executive

Sir/Madam,

In response to your advertisement published in [Newspaper], dated [Date], for the post of Sales Executive, I wish to apply for the same. I believe my qualifications, communication skills and enthusiasm make me a suitable candidate for this position. My detailed resume is enclosed for your kind consideration.

I would be grateful for an opportunity to appear for an interview at your convenience.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

Asha/Amit

Encl: Resume

#### **RESUME**

Name: Asha/Amit

Address: [Address]

Contact No.: [Phone] | Email: [Email]

Career Objective: To secure a challenging position as a Sales Executive where I can utilise my communication and interpersonal skills for the growth of the organisation.

Educational Qualifications:

- Graduation (B.Com/B.A.), [University], [Year]
- Higher Secondary (AHSEC), [Year]

Skills: Strong communication skills, persuasive ability, proficiency in MS Office, team player.

Experience: [Mention any prior work/internship, if applicable]

Languages Known: English, Hindi, Assamese

Declaration: I hereby declare that the above information is true to the best of my knowledge.

Date: [Date]

Signature: Asha/Amit

#### **SECTION-C: Grammar (20 Marks)**

### Q5. Narration (2×2=4)

(a) Reena said to the boy, "What's the matter? Why are you crying? Be cheerful."

*Ans:* Reena asked the boy what the matter was and why he was crying, and told him to be cheerful.

(b) The customer inquired if he could get a garden-roller in that shop. The assistant respectfully replied that he would get it in the hardware department.

*Ans:* The customer said, "Can I get a garden-roller in this shop?" The assistant replied respectfully, "You will get it in the hardware department."

### Q6. Voice change (any three) (3×1=3)

(a) Drive the car slowly.

*Ans:* Let the car be driven slowly.

(b) I am writing a letter now.

*Ans:* A letter is being written by me now.

(c) We should not encourage indiscipline.

*Ans:* Indiscipline should not be encouraged by us.

(d) Who wrote the Ramayana?

*Ans:* By whom was the Ramayana written?

### Q7. Correct tense forms (any five) (5×1=5)

(a) I met him while \_\_\_\_\_ (go) to his office.

*Ans:* going

(b) They \_\_\_\_\_ (live) in this place since 1970.

*Ans:* have been living

(c) The train \_\_\_\_\_ (leave) before I reached the station.

*Ans:* had left

(d) I wish I \_\_\_\_\_ (be) a bird!

*Ans:* were

(e) Your letter \_\_\_\_\_ (reach) me yesterday.

*Ans:* reached

(f) He \_\_\_\_\_ (make) a doll now.

*Ans:* is making

### Q8. Prepositions (any four) (4×1=4)

(a) What is the time \_\_\_\_\_ your watch now?

*Ans:* by

(b) The students of this college have free access \_\_\_\_\_ the Principal.

*Ans:* to

(c) You should take proper care \_\_\_\_\_ your books.

*Ans:* of

(d) A sage has no desire \_\_\_\_\_ material wealth.

*Ans:* for

### Q9. Rewrite as directed (any four) (4×1=4)

(a) Your hair is very lovely. (exclamatory)

**Ans:** What lovely hair you have!

**(b) The Bhupen Hazarika Xetu at Dhola Sadiya is the longest bridge in India. (positive degree)**

**Ans:** Very few bridges in India are as long as the Bhupen Hazarika Xetu at Dhola Sadiya.

**(c) I tried every plan. (negative, same meaning)**

**Ans:** I left no plan untried.

**(d) He wants me to help him. (complex sentence)**

**Ans:** He wants that I should help him.

## SECTION-D: Textbooks (45 Marks)

### Q10(b). Extract from 'My Mother at Sixty-Six'

**(i) Where was the speaker driving to? (1)**

**Ans:** The speaker was driving from her parents' home to Cochin.

**(ii) What did she notice when her mother sat beside her? (1)**

**Ans:** She noticed her mother dozing with her mouth open, her face pale and ashen, looking like that of a corpse.

**(iii) Find two words that mean 'sleep lightly' and 'dead body'. (1)**

**Ans:** Doze (sleep lightly); corpse (dead body)

**(iv) Why was her mother's face like that of a corpse? (1)**

**Ans:** Her mother's face looked pale and lifeless because of her advancing age and failing health, which suddenly made the poet realise, with pain, how close her mother was to death.

### Q11. Answer any three in 30–40 words (3×2=6)

**(i) How did the travellers on the highways react to the roadside stand?**

**Ans:** Most travellers sped past without a glance; a few slowed only to ask directions or to complain that the stand spoiled the scenic view, but almost none actually stopped to buy anything, leaving the family disappointed.

**(v) What is the significance of the parting words of the speaker and her smile in 'My Mother at Sixty-six'?**

**Ans:** As she leaves for the airport, the poet uses the conventional parting words "See you soon, Amma" and manages a smile — a deliberate emotional mask to hide her true fear and grief about her mother's approaching death.

**(iii) Why would quietness be an exotic moment for the speaker in 'Keeping Quiet'?**

*(Note: 'Keeping Quiet' is not part of your current syllabus list; included here for completeness.)*

**Ans:** Quietness would feel exotic because human life is normally driven by constant rush, noise and machines/engines; a shared moment of global stillness, free of activity, would be rare and strange, allowing genuine self-reflection.

### Q12. Answer any five (5×1=5)

**(b) Where does Saheb originally hail from?**

**Ans:** Saheb originally hails from Dhaka, in Bangladesh.

**(c) Which country had developed synthetic indigo?**

**Ans:** Germany had developed synthetic indigo.

**(d) Where did Gandhi stay in Muzzafarpur?**

**Ans:** Gandhi stayed at the house of Professor J.B. Kripalani in Muzzafarpur.

**(g) Name the book from which 'Memoirs of a Chota Sahib' is taken.**

**Ans:** It is taken from 'A Chota Sahib: Memoirs of a Forest Officer' by John Rowntree.

**(f) What did Sophie dream of?**

*(Note: from 'Going Places', not part of your current syllabus.)*

**Ans:** Sophie dreamed of opening her own boutique, becoming a fashion designer, and later of an imagined romance with the famous footballer Danny Casey.

**Q13. Answer any five in 30–40 words (5×2=10)**

**(c) What is the actual name of Saheb? What does it signify?**

**Ans:** Saheb's actual name is Saheb-e-Alam, which means 'lord of the universe' or 'king of the world'. The name is deeply ironic given that he is actually a poor, barefoot ragpicker living in extreme poverty.

**(d) How was a solution to the problem of indigo sharecroppers of Champaran found?**

**Ans:** Gandhi investigated the sharecroppers' grievances by recording their statements, and negotiated with the planters, leading to a settlement in which the planters agreed to refund 25 per cent of the money extracted from the peasants, and the exploitative Tinkathia system was abolished.

**(a) What words did M. Hamel write on the blackboard before dismissing the last class? What did they mean?**

*(Note: from 'The Last Lesson', not part of your current syllabus, included for completeness.)*

**Ans:** M. Hamel wrote "Viva La France!" on the blackboard, meaning "Long Live France!" — a final, deeply emotional expression of his patriotism and love for his homeland before French classes were banned in the region.

**(b) What would Franz love to do on that sunny morning instead of going to school? / (e) Why didn't Sophie want Jansie to know about her story with Danny? / (f) Peacock Island / (g) marboat**

*These questions relate to 'The Last Lesson' and 'Going Places' (not in your current syllabus), and to specific descriptive passages in 'Memoirs of a Chota Sahib' (Peacock Island, marboat) that I don't have reliable, verified text for. Please refer to your textbook/notes for these four.*

**Q14. Answer any one in 80–100 words (1×5=5)**

**(b) Describe the exploitation of the indigo sharecroppers by the English landlords. How did Gandhi help them to get an honourable settlement?**

**Ans:** Under the Tinkathia system, British planters in Champaran forced Indian peasants to grow indigo on three-twentieths (tinkathia) of their land and to sell it at prices fixed by the planters themselves, leaving farmers with almost no profit. When synthetic indigo was developed in Germany, making natural indigo less profitable, the planters, instead of releasing the farmers from their contracts, extracted heavy compensation from them for being released, exploiting their ignorance and helplessness. When Gandhi arrived at the request of Rajkumar Shukla, he began by thoroughly investigating the situation, recording hundreds of peasants' statements despite official opposition and even court summons. His fearless, non-violent resistance combined with meticulous fact-finding forced the authorities to appoint a committee, on which Gandhi himself served. Ultimately, a settlement was reached in which the planters agreed to refund 25 per cent of the money illegally extracted, and the unjust Tinkathia system was abolished, giving the sharecroppers a fair and honourable resolution.

**Q15. Answer any one in 125–150 words (1×7=7)**

*Both options ('The Enemy' — Dr. Sadao Hoki; 'On the Face of It' — Mr Lamb and Derry) are not part of your current seven-chapter syllabus. I'm skipping a full answer here to keep this focused on your actual syllabus — let me know if you'd like me to answer these anyway for general practice.*

**Q16. Answer any four in 30–40 words (4×2=8)**

**(a) What did the Maharaja decide to do when he remembered the astrologer's prediction?**

**Ans:** On remembering the astrologer's prediction that he would be killed by the hundredth tiger, the Maharaja (Tiger King) decided to hunt and kill a hundred tigers himself, to defy fate and prove the prediction wrong.

**(d) Why was Zitkala-Sa in tears on the first day in the land of apples?**

**Ans:** Zitkala-Sa was in tears because she was forced to sit still in a chair for long hours in an unfamiliar, rigid environment, and, more painfully, because her long hair — a mark of dignity and mourning tradition in her Dakota culture — was forcibly cut against her will, leaving her feeling humiliated and violated.

**(b) Who was Hana? What did she notice coming out of the mist? / (c) How did Derry get his face burnt?**

*(Note: from 'The Enemy' and 'On the Face of It' respectively, not part of your current syllabus — skipping detailed answers.)*

**(e) What is the meaning of 'Domahi'? What do people usually have for lunch on that day? / (f) How is the delicacy 'Sunga-pitha' prepared?**

*These relate to a regional Assamese cultural text I don't have reliable content for — please refer to your textbook/notes.*